

QUESTION 16. How can we buy a home without borrowing? We're planning to buy our first home, but I don't see any way we can ever buy a home without borrowing. Is it wrong to go into debt for a home?

ANSWER: Borrowing is neither a sin, nor is it forbidden scripturally. There is nothing sinful about borrowing to buy a home. Just be sure it's a home you can afford. As I said before, the decision to buy should be based on your budget. If you can buy as cheaply as rent, then buy.

Obviously, most young couples today will have to buy with a mortgage, because the price of homes is inflated through the use of credit. Without credit, the average \$100,000 home would sell for around \$15,000 to \$20,000.

However, just because you borrow to buy, it doesn't mean you have to pay on your home for 30 years. Have a goal to own your home as quickly as possible.

QUESTION 17. Should I pay all the bills? My fiancé doesn't know how to handle money. Should I pay all of the bills myself after we're married?

ANSWER: Both of you need to learn how to manage your finances, including how to balance a checkbook, pay bills, handle credit, and so on. So you need to work on a budget together. Don't allow any area of your marriage to develop a his/her attitude. Develop an "our" attitude.

It doesn't matter whether it's starting a business, buying investments, or anything else. Do it together. Pray together, study God's Word together, pay the bills together, develop a budget together, invest together, start a business together. The world teaches his/hers. God's Word teaches "ours." "House and wealth are an inheritance from fathers, but a prudent wife is from the Lord" (Proverbs 19:14).

QUESTION 18. Should I keep my inheritance separate? I have a sizable inheritance. My father suggests I keep it in my